

Nikhil Sharma

Operations Management & Business Analytics
Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University

On the 2026–2027 academic job market

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RESEARCH

Job Market Paper

2026 *Job Market Paper · Target Submission: October 2026 · M&SOM*

Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain

Sharma, N., Gray, J., & De Jong, J.

Working Papers

2026 *Preparing for Resubmission (Reject and Resubmit) · M&SOM*

Improving Recycling Quality through AI and Green Nudges: Evidence from a Field Experiment

McKie, E., Sharma, N., Chandrasekaran, A., & Cho, S.

2026 *Preparing for Resubmission (3rd Round Major Revision) · Journal of Business Logistics*

Supply Chain Intermediaries' Value Contribution: A Review and Future Opportunities

Sharma, N., Hughes, M., Gray, J., & De Jong, J.

An integrative literature review developing a conceptual framework on how and when supply chain intermediaries create and destroy value.

2026 *Preparing for Resubmission (Revision Granted) · Health Affairs Scholar*

Generic Drug Supply Chain Quality and Market Dynamics: A Cross-Sectional Observational Study of Metformin

Gray, J. V., Handfield, R., Divey, S., Sahebi-Fakhrabad, A., Sadeghi, A., Sharma, N., Light, D., Butler, P., Teasdale, B., & Schulman, K. A.

Research in Progress

2026 **Multiproduct Retail Decisions under Aggregate Contracts**

Sharma, N., Hill, J., & Mallipeddi, R.

- Dissertation Chapter 2 · Lab Study 1 complete, Lab Study 2 in planning
- Presented at POMS 2026

2026 **The Impact of Curbing Intermediary Practices on Retailers' Performance**

Sharma, N., Gray, J., & De Jong, J.

- Dissertation Chapter 3 · Data collection complete

2026 **Multi-contract Retail Decisions under Third-Party Payments**

Sharma, N., Hill, J., & Mallipeddi, R.

- Experiment design complete

Research Awards

2025 **First Place, Edward F. Hayes Advanced Research Forum, The Ohio State University**
Business category, for the dissertation paper “Regulating a Powerful Intermediary: The Effectiveness of Laws to Eliminate Adverse Pharmacy Benefit Manager Practices.”
2025 Winners

TEACHING

Instructor, Fisher College of Business

2025 **BUSMGT 3230 — Introduction to Operations Management**
Instructor of record for 36 students. **SEI: 4.8 / 5.0**

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Fisher College of Business

2022–2025 **BUSMGT 3230 — Introduction to Operations Management (x2)**
Including one fully online recitation.

2022–2025 **BUSMGT 7223, BUSMGT 2320, BUSOBA 2321, BUSOBA 4234, BUSOBA 4254, MBA 6273, BUSOBA 7201**
Project Management; Decision Sciences: Statistical Techniques; Business Analytics; Service Operations; Sustainable Projects; Data Analysis Management; Service Operations.

Earlier teaching: Ad hoc instructor, Accenture Learning & Knowledge Management (2013); mentor, Starbase CT (2016–2017) — public speaking and robotics, Hartford, CT.

EDUCATION

2022–present **Ph.D., Operations Management & Business Analytics (expected May 2027)**
Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University.
Dissertation Committee: John Gray (Chair), James Hill, Jurriaan De Jong, Rakesh Mallipeddi.

2005–2009 **B.E., Electronics and Communications**
Institute of Technology & Management, Gurgaon, India (Maharshi Dayanand University, Rohtak)

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

Upcoming

2026 **INFORMS Annual Meeting**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.
“Supply Chains, E-Commerce, and Intermediaries” Session, 2:45–4:00 PM, Sunday, November 1 (Moscone South-202, Level 2).

2026 **DSI Annual Conference**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.
Multiproduct Retail Decisions under Aggregate Contracts.

2026 **AI in Business Conference, Fisher College of Business**
Session Chair.

Past

2026	ISA Annual Meeting Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.
2026	POMS Annual Conference Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain. Multiproduct Retail Decisions under Aggregate Contracts.
2025	DSI Annual Conference Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.
2025	UIUC Supply Chain Management Conference Improving Recycling Quality through AI and Green Nudges.
2025	POMS Annual Conference Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.
2025	Indian School of Business (ISB) – POMS Workshop Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

2025–present	Emerging-Scholar Ambassadorial Core (ESAC), Journal of Operations Management Involved in the creation of “The Doctorate in Operations Management Embassy (D.O.M.E.)”
2025–2027	Session Chair POMS (2027, 2026), INFORMS Annual Meeting (2026), DSI Annual Conference (2025, 2026), AI in Business Conference, Fisher College of Business (2026).
2026	Panel Co-Moderator DSI Panel on AI in Healthcare.
2026	Ad-Hoc Reviewer Decision Sciences Journal.
—	Professional Memberships INFORMS, Production and Operations Management Society (POMS), Decision Sciences Institute (DSI), Industry Studies Association (ISA).

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Accenture, India & USA (2009–2022) — 12 years across IT operations and business analytics, with exposure to Financial Services, Life Sciences, Communication/Media/Technology, and Health & Public Services.	
2014–2022	Business Analytics Consulting, Hartford, CT — Business Insurance, Travelers
2013–2014	Business Analyst, Bangalore, India — Biopharmaceutical Research, Covance (Lab-Corp)
2012–2013	Product Development, Bangalore, India — KPN (Communication, Media & Technology)

2009–2012 **Production Operations & Quality Analyst, Bangalore, India — United Health Group**

Industry Awards

- 2019 **Top 5 Finalist Team, Accenture Global Tech Innovation Contest (North America)**
Chicago, IL, out of 350+ entries. Pitched in the “Innovate for Society” category:
- Enhancing transparency in CSR donations
 - Providing a digital identity for street vendors using blockchain platforms
- Collaborators:** Prakash Trivedi, Saurabh Gaikwad, Surendra Kushwaha, Ravindra Pratap Singh.
- 2018 **Top 5 Finalist Team, Accenture Global Tech Innovation Contest (North America)**
Chicago, IL, out of 350+ entries. Pitched in the “Innovate for Society” category:
- Transforming the Public Distribution System in developing countries using blockchain to fight corruption
- Collaborators:** Prakash Trivedi, Saurabh Gaikwad, Ravindra Pratap Singh.

SKILLS & TRAINING

Programming Languages & Software

R, STATA, LaTeX, Python, MS Office

Technology & Platform Training

Ab Initio, Databricks, AWS

Industry Exposure

Healthcare & Insurance, Pharmaceutical Technology, Communications/Media/Technology, General Insurance (P&C)

REFERENCES

- John Gray **Dean’s Distinguished Professor of Operations; Chair, Operations & Business Analytics — Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University**
gray.402@osu.edu · 614-247-8021
- James A. Hill **Professor of Operations Management — Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University**
hill.249@osu.edu · 614-247-8965
- Rakesh Mallipeddi **Assistant Professor — Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University**
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